R a m a y a n a story was enacted and vast crowds came to see it and join in the processions. It was all very crude, but that did not matter, for everyone knew the story by heart and it was carnival time.

In this way Indian mythology and old tradition crept into my mind and got mixed up with all manner of other creatures of the imagination. I do not think I ever attached very much importance to these stories as factually true, and I even criticized the magical and supernatural element in them. But they were just as imaginatively true for me as were the stories from the Arabian Nights or the *Panchatantra*, that storehouse of animal tales from which Western Asia and Europe have drawn so much.*

As I grew up other pictures crowded into my m i n d : fairy stories, both Indian and European, tales from Greek mythology, the story of J o a n of Arc, *Alice in Wonderland,* and many stories of Akbar and Birbal, Sherlock Holmes, King Arthur and his Knights,

** The story of the innumerable translations and adaptations of the 'Panchatantra' into Asiatic and European languages is a long, intricate, and fascinating one. The first known*